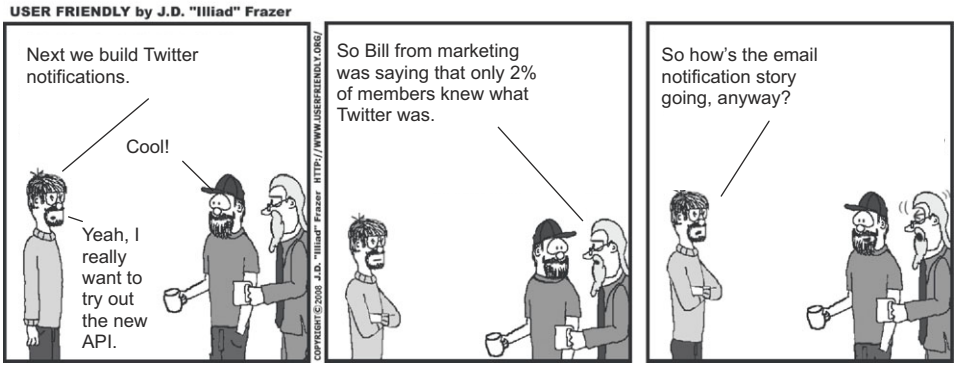


Figure 4.5 Sometimes features become less important as we learn more about them.

Next, you identify which users you think this feature will affect, or which stakeholders will benefit ❸. This helps you look at things from the point of view of the people who will be using the feature or who expect to benefit from its outcomes.

Finally, you describe the feature itself and what it's meant to do ❹. Here you focus on describing what the software does in business terms; you don't want to get too hung up on the technical details or commit yourself to a particular implementation just yet.

Sometimes it's more useful to consider a requirement not from the point of view of the end user, but from the perspective of the stakeholder who's ultimately interested in this business outcome. For example, you might find it more useful to look at things from the point of view of the business:

```
Feature: Online membership renewal
In order to reduce lost sales from lapsing memberships
As Flying High sales manager
I want members to be able to renew their membership online
```

This is the underlying goal of the business, not of the Frequent Flyer members. ❶

❷ **Who is interested in obtaining this goal?**

The feature refers to the actors whose behavior you want to influence.

This highlights an interesting point. It's really the Flying High sales manager ❷ who wants members to renew so they'll continue to book flights on Flying High planes ❶. So in this case, the real stakeholder that you need to satisfy is the sales manager, not the members. Maybe the members aren't always that motivated to renew. Maybe you need to find ways to entice them into renewing their memberships.

The format we've been using here is popular among BDD practitioners because it focuses on the business value or capability that the feature is meant to deliver. But many teams also use the more traditional "as a ... I want ... so that" format:

```
Feature: Online membership renewal
As a Frequent Flyer member
I want to be able to renew my membership online
So that I renew my membership more easily
```

Who is the main stakeholder that will benefit?

What do they want to do?

What capability or business goal are you supporting?